

Measuring Intelligence

Measures of intelligence have been used for well over a century, but the methods used and the way the results are put to use remain hotly debated, even today.

IQ scores are standardized so the curve is always centered on a score of 100

Normal distribution
When scores from IQ tests are plotted on a frequency graph, the result is a bell curve, or normal distribution, in which most people's scores cluster symmetrically around the average. For every 100 people, 68 will have an IQ score between 85 and 115. At both the upper and lower ends of the scale, the frequency falls away rapidly.

AN INDIVIDUAL'S
IQ SCORE CAN VARY
BY 20 POINTS OR
MORE DEPENDING
ON THE TEST USED



**DOES A PERSON'S
IQ STAY THE SAME?**

A child's IQ score can be quite variable with potentially dramatic changes in score over relatively short periods of time. IQ scores tend to stabilize as adults.

Following a US court ruling in 2002, prisoners with an IQ lower than 70 cannot be considered for capital punishment

IQ

Intelligence quotient (IQ) is a total score derived from a standardized test that measures aspects of intelligence, including analytical thinking and spatial recognition. There are more than a dozen tests that provide an IQ score, and they have been used to stream students and recruit to professions such as the military. Although IQ tests are statistically reliable, it has been argued that they are biased toward the cultures from which they originate.

